

MS. ABHISHREE MANIKANTAN

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International arbitration lawyer experienced in investor–state disputes, public international law and complex commercial arbitration.

BAR ADMISSION

Member, Bar Council of Delhi, India, September 2022; New York State Bar, April 2026

EDUCATION

NEW YORK UNIVERSITY SCHOOL OF LAW, New York, NY

LL.M. in International Business Regulation, Litigation & Arbitration

May 2025

Courses: Investment Treaty Arbitration, International Business Transactions

Activities: NYU Journal of International Law and Politics, Graduate Editor

SYMBIOSIS LAW SCHOOL, Pune, India

Combined B.B.A. LL.B. (Hons.), CGPA: 8.19/10

April 2022

Courses: Alternate Dispute Resolution, UNCITRAL Model Codes

Activities: Indian Constitutional Law Review, Deputy Editor-in-Chief; Career & Professional Development Cell, Head

EXPERIENCE

DEBEVOISE & PLIMPTON, London, United Kingdom

Intern, International Dispute Resolution Group

Feb 2026 – Present

- Researched & drafted issue of agency law in skeleton argument for complex insurance arbitration under LCIA rules.
- Managed client communication, collected evidence through SARs, and drafted skeleton witness statement for pro-bono case.
- BD: monitored UNCITRAL WG III, tracked ISDS developments through industry events, created client updates.

INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTE FOR SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT, Geneva, Switzerland

IFD Fellow, Economic Law & Policy Program - Investment

September – November 2025

- Researched **investor–state dispute settlement (ISDS)** mechanisms, treaty reform and investment protection frameworks.
- Drafted **policy briefs on investment treaty design**, state consent and dispute prevention.
- Analysed 60+ stakeholder submissions on reform of investment treaties and ISDS to create draft report.

S&A LAW OFFICES, New Delhi, India

Associate, Arbitration and Disputes

July 2022 – May 2024

- Advised corporate clients on **feasibility** of raising disputes and resolution **strategy** in cases valued **\$36M+** in infrastructure and mining sectors, particularly against state entities.
- **Drafted** statement of claims, rejoinders, notices of dispute, cross-examination questions, argument notes, etc. for arbitration and court proceedings.
- Extensive legal **research** on quantification of damages, credibility of expert witnesses, force majeure, and other aspects of arbitration, evidence, civil procedure and contract law.

PUBLICATIONS

- LL.M. Thesis: *What Makes a Jurisdiction Arbitration Friendly?* (Advisor: Prof Franco Ferrari; Grade: A-).
- Comment: *Balancing Party Autonomy and Public Policy in Indian Private International Law: Insights from TransAsia Private Capital v. Gaurav Dhawan* with NYU Journal of International Law and Politics, Vol 57.
- Blog: *Anti-Arbitration Injunctions: The Endless Tussle for Jurisdiction* with the American Review of International Arbitration, Columbia University Law School.
- Case Note: *Qatar Pharma et. al. v. Saudi Arabia* with IISD Investment Treaty News blog.

HONOURS

- Semester Topper Scholarship for Examination Season April 2022 for obtaining highest CGPA in final term (SLS, Pune).
- 25th Stetson International Environment Law Moot Court Competition, 2021, Runner-Up (World Rounds); 2nd Best Speaker & 2nd Best Memorial (India National Rounds).

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Native fluency in Hindi, English, Marathi. Volunteered with *There Is No Earth B*, an environmental advocacy NGO (2023). Mentored six freshmen as part of Symbiosis Law School Peer Assistance System (2020-21). Coached five teams for Moot Court Competitions (2020-21).